

Tajweed for the Holy Quran

Definition:

Tajweed means 'to improve' or 'to make better.' In Quranic recitation, it refers to a set of rules that guide the proper pronunciation of Arabic letters and words as they appear in the Quran, preserving their meanings and the beauty of the recitation.

Importance of Tajweed:

- Preservation of Meaning: Incorrect pronunciation can change meanings.
- Obedience to Allah's Command: 'Recite the Quran with measured recitation.' (Surah Al-Muzzammil 73:4)
- Following the Sunnah: The Prophet recited with Tajweed.
- Beautification: Enhances spiritual connection through melodious recitation.

Basic Rules of Tajweed with Examples:

1. Makharij al-Huruf (Articulation Points):

- Example: Qaaf is from the back of the tongue.

2. Sifaat al-Huruf (Letter Characteristics):

- Example: Ra is heavy in 'Ar-Rahman', light in 'Fir'awn'.

3. Noon Saakinah and Tanween Rules:

- Idgham: 'min ya'mal' becomes 'mi-yya'mal'
- Ikhfa: 'min shay'" with nasalization
- Iqlab: 'min ba'd' becomes 'mim ba'd'
- Izhar: 'min ghal' pronounced clearly

4. Meem Saakinah Rules:

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- Ikhfa Shafawi: 'tarmeehim bihijarah'
- Idgham Shafawi: 'lahum maghfirah'
- Izhar Shafawi: 'am lahum'

5. Qalqalah (Echo):

- Example: 'Ahad' - echo on the letter Daad

6. Madd (Prolongation):

- Madd Tabee'i: 'Qala' extended for 2 counts.

References from Hadith and Scholars:

- Prophet Muhammad (PBUH): 'The best among you are those who learn the Quran and teach it.' (Bukhari)
- Imam Ibn al-Jazari: 'Applying Tajweed is an obligation...'

Conclusion:

Learning and applying Tajweed is essential for correct and respectful recitation of the Quran. It maintains the divine message, ensures proper pronunciation, and enhances spiritual experience.